



Ervine, Craig

ZIM

vs off spin

Zimbabwe M · LHB · How to exploit — off spin plan

RUNS

454

17 dismissals · 66 inns

AVERAGE

26.7

STRIKE RATE

69.2

3-YR 97.4

MEDIAN % OF RUNS

8.7%

of team, per innings

3-YR 14.4%

CARRIES THE INNINGS

21%

innings with ≥25% of team

3-YR 18%

SUMMARY

- A solid, steady batter — no glaring weakness.
- Plan for off spin: bowl **good length pitching outside off**.
- They get out most often to balls that are **good length and on the stumps** (4.3 dismissals/100).
- Most often out **bowled** (47% of dismissals); most often to off spin (17).

COMMON THEMES

- left-hand bat, averaging 26.7 at a strike rate of 69.2.
- Carries a big share of the batting — 13.5% of team runs.
- Scores mainly through the V (44%).

STRENGTHS

- Main scoring shot is the drive (33% of runs).
- The **slog** brings them 8% of their runs vs off spin — 1.5× the typical Test batter's share. Scores unusually little off the **cut** vs off spin (3% of runs vs 7% typically).
- Starts securely — their dismissal rate barely drops once set (1.6 early vs 3.6/100); early pressure alone won't buy their wicket. Early runs come mainly off the drive (33%).

WEAKNESSES / HOW TO GET HIM

- Most often out **bowled** (47% of dismissals); most often to off spin (17).
- Vulnerable to the **good length** (averages 15 there vs 27 overall; 3.1 dismissals/100).
- Most dangerous ball: **good length and on the stumps** (4.3 dismissals/100, avg 11).

Start of Innings vs Set

Starts securely — their dismissal rate barely drops once set (1.6 early vs 3.6/100); early pressure alone won't buy their wicket. Early runs come mainly off the drive (33%).

Phase	Average	Strike rate	False-shot %	Dismissals / 100	Boundary %	Balls
First 30 balls	45.4	71	12%	1.56	8%	320
Once set (31+)	18.9	68	9%	3.57	6%	336

v Bangladesh · 1 Test · 100 balls · 60 runs · avg 60.0
Too few balls in this series to compare a plan.

v Afghanistan · 1 Test · 8 balls · 5 runs · avg 5.0
Too few balls in this series to compare a plan.

v New Zealand · 2 Tests · 228 balls · 85 runs · avg 21.2
Too few balls in this series to compare a plan.

Only the balls of each attack's pace plan that differed from what the same bowlers gave that side's other LHB top-order batters. The full dismissal detail sits in the vision playlists.

Our Best Options (simulated matchups)

From the match simulation — a tool that plays each batter-v-bowler pairing out thousands of times from their full Test profiles. Low expected average = the bowler wins the matchup. "Cohort" confidence = they have not faced enough of that type for a personal read.

Bowler	Type	Exp avg	Exp SR	Out in first 30 %	Stock wicket ball	Top dismissal	Confidence
Xavier Bartlett	Right pace	21.2	72.7	57.1	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 26.9%	High
Josh Hazlewood	Right pace	26.6	71.6	49.2	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 27.6%	Med
Nathan Ellis	Right pace	30.9	80.1	48.1	short, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 27.8%	High
Adam Zampa	Leg-spin	32.3	91.6	55.8	good length, outside off	LBW 21.5%	Cohort
Mitch Marsh	Right pace	33.9	86.4	48.5	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 27.1%	Med

Structurally, off-spin turning the ball away from the LHB is the matchup class that persists — favour that angle when the individual reads are thin.

Where They're Vulnerable (off spin)

Per bucket: batting average, strike rate, false-shot %, dismissals per 100 balls, boundary %. Pink row = their lowest-average (softest) bucket in that dimension.

Turn movement

Turn movement	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
turns away	72.0	67	2%	0.93	5%	108

Length

Length	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Full	97.0	91	3%	0.93	8%	107
Good length	14.8	46	11%	3.11	3%	289
Back of a length	42.0	93	4%	2.22	9%	45

Over vs round

Over vs round	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Round the wicket	33.9	69	11%	2.03	6%	541
Over the wicket	13.5	70	5%	5.22	10%	115

Drift

Drift	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
drifts in	67.0	57	3%	0.85	3%	118

Pitching line

Pitching line	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
outside off	23.0	50	9%	2.17	2%	46
in the channel	24.0	59	5%	2.44	5%	41
on the stumps	23.6	74	11%	3.12	8%	417
down the leg side	44.5	62	13%	1.40	5%	143

DANGER BALL — WHERE THEY'RE MOST LIKELY OUT

Good length / on the stumps

4.3 dismissals per 100 · averages 11 here · 141 balls · false shot 8%

How They Score & Get Out

Scores most of their runs through straight down the ground (44%; off 30% · leg 26% · straight 44%).

Shot types (risk) [▶ their sweep](#)

Shot	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Sweep	14.2	158	23%	11.11	29%	45
Drive	136.0	110	9%	0.81	9%	124
Work/Nudge	64.5	61	6%	0.95	1%	211

Scoring mix vs the typical Test batter (vs off spin)

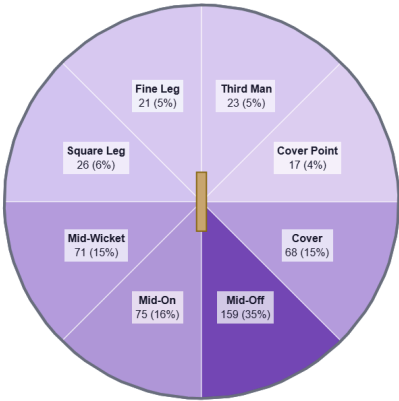
The **slog** brings them 8% of their runs vs off spin — 1.5× the typical Test batter's share. Scores unusually little off the **cut** vs off spin (3% of runs vs 7% typically).

Shot	% of their runs	Typical	Index	Pctl
Work/Nudge	33%	30%	1.1×	P62
Drive	33%	30%	1.1×	P64
Sweep	18%	14%	1.3×	P67
Slog	8%	5%	1.5×	P62
Pull/Hook	4%	7%	0.6×	P26
Cut	3%	7%	0.4×	P12
Ramp/Scoop	0%	0%	—	P51

Share of stroke-coded runs vs off spin; index = their share ÷ cohort median (69 Test batters). Highlight = signature shot; ▼ = scores unusually little there.

Most often out **bowled** (47% of dismissals); most often to off spin (17). [▶ watch dismissals](#)

Dismissal mode	Count	%
Bowled	8	47%
Caught in the field	3	18%
Caught behind	3	18%
LBW	1	6%
Run Out	1	6%
Caught	1	6%



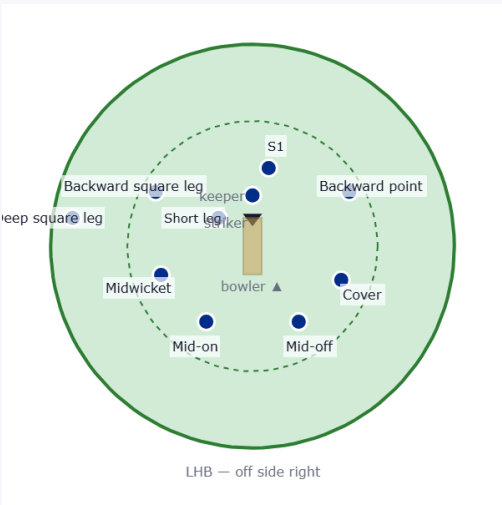
Where they score — runs by area vs off spin (mirrored for a left-hander).

Suggested Fields (the stock field ± their evidenced deviations)

Each field starts from the **stock template** for that bowler type & phase (orthodox because it works), then makes at most **three** changes — each one earned by a trigger in **their** game clearing the cohort P75 bar (do they lap, cut, pull, score square, edge early?). **Change** rows are highlighted with their stat; **Stock** rows carry the orthodoxy line. The read line backtests the changes against the pure stock field. Early = first 30 balls; Set = once in. Drawn from behind the bowler (bowler bottom, striker top); off side is on the right.

Field vs off spin

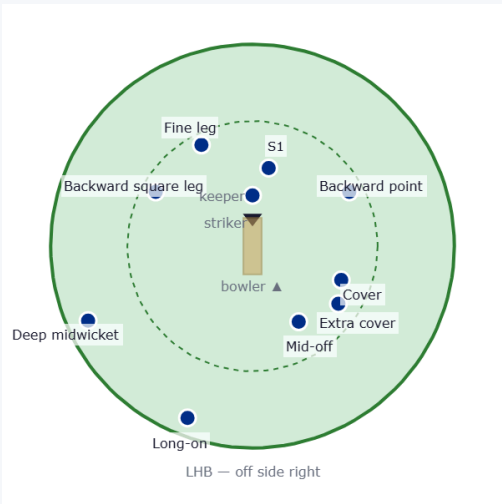
Early — first 30 balls · 320 balls



Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward square leg	Change	He works 38% of his runs to leg (P88) — squarer leg-side saver.
Short leg	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward point	Stock	Standard stock position.
Cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-off	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-on	Stock	Standard stock position.
Midwicket	Stock	Standard stock position.
Deep square leg	Stock	Standard stock position.

Stock field + 1 change (highlighted).

Once set · 336 balls



Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward point	Stock	Standard stock position.
Cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Extra cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-off	Stock	Standard stock position.
Long-on	Stock	Standard stock position.
Deep midwicket	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward square leg	Change	He works 38% of his runs to leg (P88) — squarer leg-side saver.
Fine leg	Stock	Standard stock position.

Stock field + 1 change (highlighted).

Floating fielder: They score only 4% of their runs where backward square leg stands — the spare run-saver to move as the game asks.